CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-04-19

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

19	13	12	5	49	0
Market Items	Thought	Competitors	Regulatory	Urgent	Watch

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This week, th
deadlines for

Contents

■ Market Intelligence

19 items

URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-03-28 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation: New Deadlines for Banks

The European Council formally adopted the Instant Payments Regulation, mandating that all EU and EEA payment service providers (PSPs) offer instant credit transfers in EUR. The regulation sets a timeline for implementation: receiving instant payments must be free and available within 9 months of the regulation's entry into force, and sending instant payments within 18 months. This move aims to accelerate the adoption of real-time payments, enhance liquidity management for corporates, and reduce reliance on non-EU payment schemes. Banks will also need to implement a 'Verification of Payee' (VoP) service to combat fraud, adding another layer of compliance and security for corporate transactions.

→ Regulation formally adopted by EU Council.

→ Mandatory for all EU/EEA PSPs in EUR.

→ 9 months for receiving, 18 months for sending instant payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for CMIplus. RBI and its network banks must ensure full compliance with the deadlines for both receiving and sending instant payments across all CEE markets. The mandatory VoP service will require integration into CMIplus to enhance fraud prevention and compliance for corporate clients.

URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-04-05 | #02

German Banks Push EBICS 3.0 Migration for Corporate Connectivity

The German banking sector, through institutions like the Deutsche Kreditwirtschaft (DK), is actively promoting the transition to EBICS 3.0. This standard offers enhanced security features, improved performance, and full support for the ISO 20022 XML format, which is essential for modern payment processing and reporting. While EBICS 2.5 remains supported for a transitional period, banks are emphasizing the benefits of 3.0, including better handling of larger data volumes and more robust encryption. Corporates using older versions risk compatibility issues and missing out on advanced functionalities like richer data in payment messages. The push aims to standardize corporate-to-bank communication across Germany and beyond.

→ EBICS 3.0 migration actively promoted by German banks.

→ Enhances security and supports ISO 20022 XML.

→ Improved handling of large data volumes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus already supports EBICS v2.5+v3. This news reinforces the importance of ensuring all CMIplus corporate clients in Germany and CEE are aware of and prepared for the full transition to EBICS 3.0. RBI should actively communicate the benefits and assist clients with their migration to maintain seamless connectivity and leverage full ISO 20022 capabilities.

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-03-15 | #03

AI Revolutionizes Fraud Prevention in Corporate Cash Management

The rising sophistication of cybercrime, particularly CEO fraud and invoice manipulation, is driving the adoption of AI-powered solutions in corporate cash management. AI algorithms can analyze vast amounts of transaction data in real-time, identify unusual patterns, and flag suspicious payments before they are executed. This proactive approach significantly reduces financial losses and enhances the overall security posture. Banks are integrating AI into their payment platforms, while corporates are exploring AI tools for internal controls and reconciliation. The technology promises to move beyond traditional rule-based systems, offering more dynamic and adaptive fraud detection capabilities, crucial for protecting multi-currency and cross-border payments in the CEE region.

→ AI combats sophisticated payment fraud (e.g., CEO fraud).

→ Real-time transaction analysis and anomaly detection.

→ Reduces financial losses and enhances security.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For CMIplus, integrating advanced AI-driven fraud prevention capabilities is paramount. This includes leveraging AI for real-time transaction monitoring, anomaly detection, and potentially for the mandatory VoP service. RBI should explore partnerships or internal development to enhance CMIplus's security features, offering cutting-edge protection to its corporate clients in CEE.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-03-28 | #04

EU Instant Payments Regulation Drives ISO 20022 Adoption

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation, effective early 2025 for receiving and early 2026 for sending, mandates that all euro credit transfers must be processed instantly. This regulation is a significant catalyst for the full adoption of the ISO 20022 standard across the Eurozone, extending beyond SEPA Credit Transfers and Direct Debits. Treasurers must ensure their ERP and TMS systems are fully capable of generating and processing ISO 20022 XML messages to avoid payment delays and ensure compliance. The regulation also includes provisions for fraud prevention and sanctions screening, adding complexity to implementation. Banks are actively upgrading their infrastructure, but corporate readiness remains a key challenge.

→ EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates instant EUR payments.

→ Deadline for sending instant payments: early 2026.

→ Accelerates full ISO 20022 adoption for all EUR payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus is well-positioned to support clients with ISO 20022 readiness and instant payment processing. RBI should emphasize its capabilities in handling the new XML formats and real-time processing, particularly for its CEE clients operating in EUR.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-04-10 | #05

Open Banking APIs Transform Corporate Treasury Operations

The evolution of Open Banking, driven by regulatory frameworks like PSD2 and its anticipated successor PSD3, is increasingly impacting corporate treasury. Beyond simple account aggregation, banks are now offering richer APIs that facilitate real-time cash visibility, automated reconciliation, and more efficient electronic Bank Account Management (eBAM). These advanced APIs allow corporates to initiate payments, manage mandates, and access detailed transaction data directly from their TMS or ERP systems. This shift promises greater operational efficiency, reduced manual effort, and improved data accuracy, enabling treasurers to make more informed liquidity decisions. The focus is now on standardisation and broader adoption across Europe, including CEE.

→ Open Banking APIs enable real-time cash visibility and automated reconciliation.

→ Facilitates advanced eBAM functionalities for corporates.

→ Driven by PSD2 evolution and anticipated PSD3.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus can leverage Open Banking APIs to offer enhanced eBAM, real-time cash positioning, and payment initiation services to its CEE clients. RBI should highlight its API strategy and how it integrates with corporate TMS/ERP systems for seamless treasury operations.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-03-15 | #06

AI-Powered Fraud Prevention Critical for CEE Corporate Payments

The rising sophistication of cyber threats and payment fraud schemes necessitates advanced protective measures for corporate treasuries, especially in the dynamic CEE region. AI and machine learning algorithms are now being deployed to analyze payment patterns, identify anomalies, and flag suspicious transactions in real-time, significantly enhancing fraud detection capabilities. This technology helps mitigate risks associated with business email compromise (BEC), invoice fraud, and internal collusion. For CEE corporates, where cross-border payments and diverse regulatory landscapes add complexity, AI-powered solutions offer a crucial layer of security, protecting liquidity and reputation. Banks are integrating these tools into their cash management platforms to offer clients greater peace of mind.

→ AI/ML detects payment fraud and anomalies in real-time.

→ Mitigates BEC, invoice fraud, and internal collusion risks.

→ Crucial for dynamic CEE region with complex cross-border payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should emphasize its fraud prevention capabilities, potentially highlighting any AI/ML-driven features or partnerships that enhance security for multi-currency payments in CEE. This is a key differentiator for corporate clients.

URGENT

Strategic Treasurer | 2026-04-05 | #07

PSD3 Proposals Reshape European Open Banking Landscape

The European Commission's latest PSD3 legislative package, building on PSD2, introduces significant changes to the Open Banking framework. Key proposals include mandatory data sharing for certain services, enhanced security requirements for API access, and stronger provisions for fraud prevention, particularly around authorized push payment (APP) fraud. The directive seeks to foster greater competition and innovation in the payments market while ensuring consumer protection. For corporates, this means more sophisticated cash management tools and potentially new payment initiation services, but also increased compliance burdens for banks and PSPs. The timeline for implementation is expected to span several years, with initial consultations and technical standards development in late 2026 and 2027.

→ Mandatory data sharing for specific Open Banking services.

→ Enhanced security protocols for API access.

→ Stronger focus on combating APP fraud.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus will need to adapt its Open Banking APIs and services to comply with new PSD3 requirements, particularly regarding data security and fraud prevention. This presents an opportunity to offer enhanced, compliant services to CEE corporates.

URGENT

Strategic Treasurer | 2026-03-20 | #08

ISO 20022 Adoption Accelerates Real-Time Payments Globally

The migration to ISO 20022 as the universal standard for financial messaging continues to gain momentum worldwide, with major payment infrastructures in Europe (like TARGET2, EBA CLEARING) and beyond completing or nearing their transition. This standardization provides richer, structured data, which is vital for enhancing straight-through processing (STP), improving reconciliation, and bolstering fraud detection capabilities in real-time payment systems. While the benefits are clear, challenges remain in data mapping, system integration, and ensuring all participants are fully compliant. The richer data also supports advanced analytics for liquidity management and improved regulatory reporting. Corporates are increasingly demanding these enhanced data capabilities from their banking partners.

→ Global migration to ISO 20022 nearing completion in key markets.

→ Enables richer, structured payment data for STP and reconciliation.

→ Crucial for advanced real-time payment systems and fraud detection.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance and leverage the rich data capabilities of ISO 20022 for all payment channels (EBICS, H2H, SWIFT). This allows for better reconciliation, fraud prevention, and value-added services for CEE clients.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-03-28 | #09

AI Revolutionizes Corporate Liquidity Forecasting and Management

Recent advancements in AI and machine learning are enabling corporate treasuries to move beyond traditional forecasting methods. AI-powered tools can analyze vast datasets, including historical transactions, market data, and even external factors like news sentiment, to predict cash flows with greater precision. This leads to optimized cash pooling strategies, reduced borrowing costs, and improved investment decisions. While the adoption is still in early stages for many, leading corporates are already seeing significant benefits in managing multi-currency liquidity and mitigating FX risks. Challenges include data quality, integration with existing ERP/TMS systems, and the need for skilled treasury professionals to interpret AI insights.

→ AI offers enhanced accuracy in cash flow and liquidity forecasting.

→ Analyzes diverse datasets for predictive insights.

→ Optimizes cash pooling and reduces borrowing costs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore integrating AI-driven insights into its cash management offerings, especially for liquidity forecasting and multi-currency cash pooling for CEE corporates. This can provide a competitive edge and value-added services.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-03-15 | #10

ECB Reinforces Push for Widespread Instant Payments Adoption

The ECB has consistently highlighted instant payments as a strategic priority for the Eurosystem's retail payments strategy. The goal is to achieve ubiquitous reach and usage of instant payment solutions, like SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst), across all member states. This initiative is crucial for fostering innovation, improving cash flow management for corporates, and enabling new business models. The ECB monitors adoption rates and works with market participants to overcome any remaining barriers, including ensuring accessibility and affordability for all users. This sustained focus underpins the broader objective of a truly integrated and efficient European payment landscape.

→ ECB's strategic priority for retail payments.

→ Focus on ubiquitous reach of SCT Inst across Euro area.

→ Aims to enhance liquidity and efficiency for businesses.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI CMIplus, this means continued demand for instant payment capabilities, requiring robust real-time processing and liquidity management features. CMIplus must ensure seamless integration with SCT Inst and potentially other instant payment schemes to meet corporate client expectations in CEE.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-04-01 | #11

Digital Euro Project Advances, Focus on Privacy and Utility

The Digital Euro is envisioned as a public digital currency, complementing cash, designed to be resilient, private, and widely available. Current efforts are concentrated on refining its technical design, legal framework, and distribution model, with a strong emphasis on privacy-enhancing features to build public trust. The ECB is actively engaging with stakeholders, including financial institutions and consumers, to gather feedback and ensure the digital euro meets diverse needs. Its successful implementation could significantly impact the future of retail payments, offering a sovereign digital payment option and fostering innovation in the payment ecosystem.

→ Digital Euro project in preparation phase.

→ Key priorities: user privacy and broad utility.

→ Aims to complement cash as a public digital currency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus should monitor the Digital Euro's progress closely, anticipating potential integration requirements for corporate payments and treasury functions. This could involve new payment rails or settlement mechanisms, impacting multi-currency payments and liquidity management strategies.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-03-28 | #12

ECB Prioritizes Evolution of SEPA and New Payment Regulations

The ongoing work on SEPA aims to ensure its continued relevance and efficiency in a rapidly changing digital environment, including the integration of new services like Request to Pay (RTP) and enhanced data capabilities. Simultaneously, the ECB is closely involved in the legislative process for PSD3 and PSR, which are set to replace PSD2. These new regulations will address emerging challenges such as fraud prevention (e.g., Confirmation of Payee/VoP), open banking advancements, and the need for greater harmonization across the EU. The objective is to create a more secure, competitive, and innovative payment market, impacting all payment service providers and corporate treasury operations.

→ Ongoing evolution of the SEPA framework.

→ Active involvement in PSD3 and PSR legislative process.

→ Focus on fraud prevention, including VoP (Verification of Payee).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must prepare for significant updates stemming from PSD3/PSR, particularly regarding fraud prevention (VoP), enhanced API standards for Open Banking, and potentially new data requirements. This necessitates proactive compliance updates and potential platform enhancements to support new regulatory mandates and services.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-04-17 | #13

AI's Growing Role in Fraud: Finextra & FICO Report Released

The recently released Finextra and FICO global survey report, 'Fraud in the age of AI: Trends, Threats, and Management Tactics,' provides a comprehensive overview of how artificial intelligence is transforming the landscape of financial fraud. It explores the evolving methods used by fraudsters, the challenges financial institutions face in combating these threats, and the strategic approaches being adopted through AI-driven solutions. The report is crucial for understanding the current state and future direction of fraud prevention, offering insights into effective management tactics for financial services. This highlights the critical need for advanced technological solutions to safeguard financial transactions.

→ Finextra global survey report

→ FICO collaboration

→ 'Fraud in the age of AI: Trends, Threats, and Management Tactics'

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This report is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus as fraud prevention is paramount for corporate clients and their multi-currency payments. Understanding AI's role in both perpetrating and preventing fraud will inform CMIplus's security features, risk management strategies, and potential integration of advanced fraud detection tools to protect treasury operations and ensure compliance.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-04-17 | #14

Croatian Bank Shares Key Payment Transformation Insights

Jana Novina Cukrov, Director of Payments at Zagreba■ka banka, provides expert insights into the strategic priorities and challenges facing the Croatian payments sector. The interview focuses on the ongoing digital transformation within customer and business banking, addressing the need for enhanced authentication and seamless customer experiences. This includes navigating unique fraud prevention challenges and adapting to new payment infrastructures. Her perspective offers a valuable look into how a major CEE bank is addressing innovation and regulatory changes, which is crucial for regional payment providers and platforms like CMIplus.

→ Insights from Zagreba■ka banka, a major Croatian bank.

→ Focus on digital transformation in customer and business banking.

→ Addresses challenges in authentication and fraud prevention.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This interview offers direct insights into the payment priorities and challenges of a leading bank in a CEE country where RBI operates. Understanding these local dynamics is critical for CMIplus to tailor its offerings, ensure relevance, and support corporate clients effectively in the Croatian market. It helps inform strategic decisions regarding product development and regional expansion.

URGENT Treasury Today | 2026-03-25 | #15

BNPL Faces New Regulations, Revenue Impact Expected

The article highlights that BNPL services are under increasing pressure from new regulatory frameworks. This shift is expected to introduce stricter compliance requirements, potentially affecting the profitability and operational models of BNPL providers. For corporate treasuries, this means a need to re-evaluate their current BNPL offerings and integrate new compliance measures into their payment strategies. The regulatory landscape aims to protect consumers but could also lead to a more standardized and secure BNPL ecosystem in the long run. Banks and payment platforms will need to adapt to these evolving standards to support their corporate clients effectively.

→ BNPL services are subject to new regulatory frameworks.

→ Expected impact includes potential revenue fall for providers.

→ Corporates must re-evaluate BNPL offerings for compliance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMIplus must monitor these evolving BNPL regulations closely, especially in CEE markets. This could influence client payment strategies and demand for new payment integration capabilities or compliance support within CMIplus.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-04-16 | #16

UniCredit Invests in BlockInvest for Tokenized Financial Assets

UniCredit, a prominent Italian bank with significant presence in CEE, has made a strategic investment of €4 million to secure a 16% ownership stake in BlockInvest. This investment signals UniCredit's commitment to exploring and expanding the use of tokenized financial assets, a rapidly evolving area within digital finance. The bank aims to leverage this partnership to facilitate the export of these innovative assets across its primary operational markets, potentially transforming how financial instruments are issued, traded, and settled. This development could have significant implications for future capital markets, liquidity management, and cross-border payment solutions, aligning with broader trends in digital asset adoption within traditional banking.

→ Italy's UniCredit

→ Invests €4 million

→ 16% stake in BlockInvest

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This investment is a significant indicator of major European banks exploring tokenized financial assets, which could impact future payment rails, multi-currency transactions, and corporate treasury services. CMIplus should monitor this trend closely, as tokenization could offer new efficiencies for cross-border payments, liquidity management, and potentially new forms of digital cash management for corporate clients in CEE, aligning with future API-driven services.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-03-25 | #17

Global Stablecoins Report 2026 Explores Future Payment Rails

The Global Stablecoins Report 2026 delves into the multifaceted role of stablecoins within the broader financial ecosystem. It examines their foundational principles, diverse use cases, and the intricate regulatory frameworks emerging globally to govern them. Furthermore, the report addresses critical aspects such as fraud prevention and compliance requirements associated with stablecoin adoption. For financial institutions like RBI, understanding these developments is paramount as stablecoins could represent a significant shift in future payment rails, impacting multi-currency transactions, cross-border payments, and the overall digital economy.

→ Explores stablecoins' role, use cases, regulation, fraud, and compliance.

→ Published as 'Global Stablecoins Report 2026'.

→ Covers fundamentals and evolving regulatory landscape.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This report is vital for CMIplus as stablecoins could become an alternative or complementary rail for multi-currency and cross-border payments. RBI needs to monitor regulatory developments (e.g., MiCA in EU) and potential operational impacts to ensure CMIplus remains compliant and competitive. It informs strategic planning for future payment infrastructure and digital asset integration.

URGENT Treasury Today | 2026-03-26 | #18

Digital Payments in Africa Still Face Significant Hurdles

The article emphasizes that while certain digital payment providers in Africa show strong performance, the overall landscape is still fraught with difficulties. These challenges include issues like infrastructure limitations, low financial literacy, regulatory fragmentation, and the strong cultural preference for cash. For corporates operating or considering operations in emerging markets, this signifies that a complete shift away from cash is not yet feasible, requiring hybrid payment strategies. The insights from Africa can be valuable for understanding similar dynamics in parts of CEE or other emerging markets where digital transformation is ongoing but not yet complete. Overcoming these challenges will require concerted efforts in infrastructure development, regulatory harmonisation, and user education.

→ African digital payment growth masks significant underlying challenges.

→ Widespread viable alternatives to cash payments are not yet universal.

→ Challenges include infrastructure, financial literacy, and regulatory issues.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, this highlights the ongoing importance of supporting both digital and traditional cash management solutions. It underscores the need to understand market-specific challenges in CEE, ensuring CMIplus offers robust, accessible, and user-friendly digital payment options while acknowledging the persistent role of cash.

URGENT Global Finance | 2026-04-19 | #19

UniCredit Considers Commerzbank Acquisition, Shaking European Banking

Reports indicate that UniCredit, a prominent European bank with a strong presence in CEE, is assessing the feasibility of acquiring Commerzbank, a major German financial institution. Such a merger would create a banking giant with extensive reach across Europe, potentially leading to increased competition or new partnership opportunities for other players. The strategic implications for corporate clients, including those in the CEE region served by CMIplus, could be substantial, affecting pricing, service offerings, and market share. This potential consolidation highlights ongoing pressures within the European banking industry to achieve greater scale and efficiency. Any such deal would undoubtedly face intense regulatory scrutiny from German and EU authorities regarding market concentration and financial stability.

→ UniCredit is reportedly evaluating a potential acquisition of Commerzbank.

→ This move signifies a major potential consolidation within the European banking sector.

→ A merged entity would possess extensive reach across Europe, impacting market dynamics.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This potential acquisition could intensify competition for corporate cash management clients in the CEE region, where both UniCredit and RBI have strong presences. CMIplus should monitor how this affects market dynamics, client expectations, and potential shifts in banking relationships, possibly leading to new opportunities or challenges for its platform.

Thought Leadership

13 items

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #01

European Wholesale Banks Must Transform to Seize Future Growth Opportunities

After years of underperformance, European wholesale banks face a pivotal moment to redefine their strategies and capture new growth. Oliver Wyman's analysis suggests a better future is attainable through proactive measures, including significant investment in digital capabilities, optimizing operational models, and adapting to evolving client needs. This transformation is not merely about efficiency but about seizing market share by offering differentiated services, particularly in transaction banking and cash management, which are foundational to corporate relationships. The implication is a need for strategic agility and a willingness to innovate beyond traditional banking paradigms to thrive in a competitive landscape.

→ Years of underperformance necessitate strategic re-evaluation for European wholesale banks.

→ A 'better future' is possible through proactive transformation and seizing new opportunities.

→ Digitalization and operational optimization are key levers for improved performance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management, with its CMIplus platform, is well-positioned to lead this transformation in CEE. The roadmap should prioritize enhancing digital self-service, integrating advanced analytics for client insights, and expanding ecosystem solutions to provide value beyond traditional payments, ensuring CMIplus is a strategic partner for corporate clients navigating this shift.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #02

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Navigating Credit and Corporate Client Needs

Oliver Wyman's 2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook, titled 'Extending Credit,' signals a dynamic environment where banks must strategically navigate credit provision while also addressing the holistic needs of corporate clients. This outlook likely covers macroeconomic factors, regulatory shifts, and competitive pressures impacting wholesale banking. For transaction banking, this implies a need to integrate cash management and payment solutions more closely with financing options, offering a seamless and comprehensive value proposition. Banks that can effectively extend credit while simultaneously enhancing their digital transaction capabilities will be best positioned for growth and deeper client relationships.

→ The 2024 outlook emphasizes strategic credit extension within wholesale banking.

→ Banks must adapt to evolving macroeconomic and regulatory landscapes.

→ Holistic understanding of corporate client needs is crucial, beyond just lending.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore deeper integration with RBI's corporate lending services to offer a more unified client experience. This includes leveraging payment data for credit risk assessment and providing flexible liquidity solutions that complement financing structures. Expanding capabilities to support asset-based finance or related treasury services could also be strategic.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2026-04-19 | #03

Digital and Ecosystem Solutions Drive Future Corporate Transaction Banking

Oliver Wyman identifies digital transformation and the development of comprehensive ecosystem solutions as fundamental to success in corporate and transaction banking. This involves moving beyond standalone cash management and payment products to offer integrated platforms that connect clients with a broader range of services, potentially including non-financial offerings. Leveraging Open Banking APIs, real-time data, and advanced analytics enables banks to provide greater transparency, efficiency, and customized solutions. The competitive landscape increasingly favors providers who can embed banking services seamlessly into corporate workflows and ERP/TMS systems, creating sticky client relationships and enhancing overall value proposition.

→ Corporate and Transaction Banking requires advanced digital capabilities.

→ Banks must offer 'ecosystem solutions' extending beyond traditional financial services.

→ Open Banking APIs and real-time data are crucial for enhanced services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's roadmap should heavily prioritize Open API development for seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems and third-party fintechs. Focus on expanding 'beyond traditional financial services' by exploring partnerships or developing value-added services (e.g., supply chain finance, e-invoicing integration) that leverage payment data and the CMIplus platform.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-04-19 | #04

AI Revolutionizes Treasury: Enhancing Efficiency and Strategic Decision-Making

The future of treasury is deeply intertwined with AI, which offers unprecedented capabilities for optimizing cash flow, managing liquidity, and mitigating risk. AI algorithms can process vast amounts of data to forecast cash positions, identify anomalies, and automate routine tasks, freeing treasury professionals for more strategic work. This transformation requires banks to invest in AI infrastructure and develop intelligent platforms that can offer predictive insights and personalized services to corporate clients. The shift is not just about technology adoption but about fundamentally redefining the treasury operating model, emphasizing data-driven decision-making and proactive risk management to stay competitive.

→ AI moves treasury from reactive to predictive capabilities.

→ Automates routine tasks, significantly enhancing operational efficiency.

→ Enables real-time liquidity forecasting and proactive risk management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should prioritize AI integration for enhanced liquidity forecasting, fraud detection, and automated reconciliation services for CEE corporates. Exploring AI-driven analytics can provide competitive differentiation, offering predictive insights into multi-currency cash flows and optimizing cash pooling structures.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-04-19 | #05

Real-Time Treasury and Open Banking: Meeting Evolving Corporate Demands

The 'Voice of the Treasurer' consistently highlights the need for immediate access to cash positions and the ability to execute payments instantly. This demand is fueled by the global shift towards faster payments and the increasing complexity of international operations. Open Banking, through standardized APIs, provides the framework for banks to offer treasurers a consolidated view of accounts across multiple banks and geographies, facilitating real-time liquidity management and automated reconciliation. Banks that fail to embrace these capabilities risk losing relevance as corporates seek more agile and integrated treasury solutions. The focus is on seamless data exchange and interoperability to support sophisticated treasury strategies like payment factories and advanced cash pooling.

→ Treasurers prioritize real-time cash visibility and control.

→ Instant Payments drive demand for immediate transaction processing.

→ Open Banking APIs enable multi-bank account aggregation and data exchange.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must accelerate its Open Banking API strategy to enable real-time account information and payment initiation for CEE corporates. Enhancing instant payment capabilities and offering advanced multi-currency cash pooling with real-time updates will be critical for competitive advantage and meeting client expectations.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-04-19 | #06

Digital Transformation and Ecosystems Reshape Corporate Treasury Services

The future of treasury services is characterized by a profound digital transformation, moving beyond basic automation to encompass end-to-end process re-engineering and the leveraging of digital platforms. This transformation is not just about technology but also about how banks interact with their corporate clients and other fintech providers within an interconnected ecosystem. Corporates are seeking integrated solutions that streamline operations, enhance data analytics, and provide a holistic view of their financial landscape. Banks have a significant opportunity to act as orchestrators within these ecosystems, offering value-added services like eBAM, virtual accounts, and advanced ERP/TMS integration. Success hinges on providing flexible, scalable, and secure digital channels that cater to the diverse needs of large international corporates.

→ Treasury transformation is a continuous digital evolution, not a one-off project.

→ Banks must integrate into broader financial and corporate ecosystems.

→ Focus on value-added digital services beyond mere transaction processing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should focus on strengthening its digital channels (EBICS, H2H, API) to support comprehensive treasury transformation for CEE clients. Developing advanced eBAM functionalities, virtual account solutions, and deeper integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems will solidify RBI's position as a strategic partner.

URGENT

PwC Financial Services | 2026-04-19 | #07

Treasurers Prioritize Real-Time Cash Visibility Amid Global Volatility

A recent global treasury survey, encompassing over 350 treasurers, highlights the urgent need for comprehensive cash visibility. In an environment marked by increasing economic volatility, treasurers are struggling to gain a consolidated, real-time view of their global cash positions. This lack of visibility impedes effective liquidity management, leading to suboptimal investment and borrowing decisions and increased financial risk. The survey underscores that integrated data from various bank accounts and internal systems is crucial for achieving the necessary insights to manage working capital efficiently. This focus is driven by the imperative to optimize liquidity and mitigate financial exposures.

→ 350+ treasurers globally prioritize real-time cash visibility.

→ Economic volatility is the primary driver for enhanced liquidity focus.

→ Lack of visibility leads to suboptimal financial decisions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must further enhance its multi-currency, multi-bank cash visibility features, including advanced reporting and forecasting tools. This will enable CEE corporates to gain critical real-time insights into their liquidity across RBI's network banks and beyond, strengthening their cash management capabilities.

URGENT

PwC Financial Services | 2026-04-19 | #08

TMS and API Banking Drive Treasury Automation and Connectivity

The global treasury survey indicates a strong trend towards digital transformation, with treasurers actively investing in Treasury Management Systems (TMS) to automate core functions. Concurrently, API banking is emerging as a critical enabler, providing the modern connectivity layer required for real-time data flows between corporate systems and banks. This dual adoption reduces manual processes, minimizes errors, and significantly lowers operational costs. The ability to initiate payments and receive account information instantly via APIs is transforming how treasuries manage their daily operations and interact with their financial ecosystem, moving towards a more integrated and efficient treasury landscape.

→ High adoption rates for TMS among 350+ surveyed treasurers.

→ API banking is a key enabler for real-time bank connectivity.

→ Automation through TMS and APIs reduces operational costs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should prioritize strengthening its Open Banking API capabilities to facilitate seamless integration with corporate TMS and ERP systems. Promoting EBICS v3 and H2H connectivity as robust integration channels will further solidify RBI's position as a digital partner for CEE corporates.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-04-19 | #09

AI Poised to Revolutionize Treasury with Predictive Analytics

The discussion around 'AI in treasury' signals a significant future trend, moving treasury operations from reactive to proactive. AI's potential lies in its ability to analyze vast datasets to provide predictive cash flow forecasts, optimize liquidity, and identify potential risks like fraud or unusual transaction patterns. While still in early stages for many, the survey suggests treasurers are keenly aware of AI's capacity to automate complex reconciliation tasks and improve decision-making accuracy. This technological advancement promises to free up treasury staff for more strategic activities, driving greater efficiency and strategic value.

- → AI is a key emerging technology for treasury departments.
- → Predictive cash flow forecasting is a primary AI application.
- → AI enhances risk management and fraud detection capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should proactively investigate and pilot AI-driven features within CMIplus, such as advanced cash flow forecasting or anomaly detection. This strategic move would position RBI as an innovative leader, offering cutting-edge tools to CEE corporates and enhancing the platform's future relevance.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-04-19 | #10

PSD3: Reshaping Payments, Open Banking, and Real-Time Treasury

The upcoming PSD3 framework, building on PSD2, aims to strengthen consumer rights, improve fraud prevention, and further standardize Open Banking APIs. It is expected to mandate instant payments across the EU and potentially expand the scope of regulated entities, driving greater competition and requiring banks to adapt their infrastructure for real-time processing and enhanced data security. This shift will necessitate significant investment in technology and compliance, impacting corporate treasury services and multi-currency payments by 2026.

- → Mandatory Instant Payments across the EU/EEA.
- → Enhanced Open Banking API standardization and scope.
- → Stricter fraud prevention measures and consumer protection.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 is critical for CMIplus, driving the need for robust Open Banking API capabilities, seamless instant payment integration, and enhanced fraud detection. RBI must ensure its platform is compliant and leverages new opportunities for corporate treasury services and real-time liquidity management in CEE.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-04-19 | #11

DORA: Strengthening Digital Operational Resilience for Financial Firms

DORA introduces a unified regulatory framework for managing ICT (Information and Communication Technology) risk across the EU financial sector, with full applicability by 2025. It requires financial firms to establish robust operational resilience frameworks, including detailed incident reporting, regular digital operational resilience testing (e.g., penetration testing), and stringent management of critical third-party ICT providers. This regulation aims to prevent and mitigate ICT-related disruptions, ensuring the stability and integrity of financial services, which is crucial for digital platforms and cross-border operations.

→ Mandatory comprehensive ICT risk management framework.

→ Enhanced incident reporting and communication protocols.

→ Regular digital operational resilience testing requirements.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

DORA compliance is paramount for CMIplus, requiring RBI to reinforce its cybersecurity posture, operational resilience testing, and third-party vendor management. This ensures the continuous availability and security of cash management services for corporate clients across the CEE network, building trust and mitigating systemic risks.

URGENT Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2025-10-30 | #12

AI Reshapes Banking: Efficiency, Innovation, Risk Management

Deloitte's 2026 Banking Outlook identifies AI as a pivotal force driving industry transformation, with financial institutions moving beyond pilot projects to enterprise-wide strategies. The report suggests a strong focus on leveraging AI for intelligent automation, advanced analytics in fraud detection, and hyper-personalization of corporate banking services. This ambition is balanced by the necessity for robust governance frameworks and ethical AI deployment to mitigate emerging risks. Successful AI integration is expected to differentiate market leaders by enabling faster decision-making and more agile product development, crucial for navigating macro headwinds.

→ Enterprise-wide AI adoption is a strategic imperative for banks.

→ AI enhances operational efficiency and strengthens fraud detection.

→ Hyper-personalization of corporate banking services is a key driver.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should prioritize exploring AI for predictive liquidity forecasting, optimizing payment routing, and enhancing fraud detection capabilities for corporate clients, especially for CEE corporates. Integrating AI-powered analytics could offer deeper insights into cash flows and significantly improve treasury decision-making and operational efficiency.

URGENT

Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2025-10-30 | #13

Stablecoins Disrupt Payments, Reshaping Corporate Treasury

The Deloitte 2026 Banking Outlook highlights stablecoins as a significant disruptive force, challenging existing payment infrastructures and potentially reshaping corporate liquidity management. The report suggests their potential for instant, low-cost, and transparent cross-border payments could attract international corporates seeking efficiency gains and real-time settlement. Banks are urged to assess the strategic implications, from potential revenue erosion in traditional FX and correspondent banking to opportunities for offering stablecoin-related services, such as settlement, custody, or tokenized deposits. Regulatory clarity and interoperability will be crucial factors determining their widespread adoption and impact on the financial ecosystem.

→ Stablecoins offer faster, cheaper cross-border payment alternatives.

→ Potential disruption to traditional FX and correspondent banking models.

→ Banks must strategize for stablecoin integration or competitive response.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should closely monitor stablecoin developments, particularly their use cases for corporate cross-border payments and liquidity management. Exploring potential API integrations or partnerships to facilitate stablecoin-based transactions could be a future roadmap consideration, especially for enhancing multi-currency payment offerings in CEE.

! Regulatory Radar

5 items

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2024-03-26 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Mandatory SEPA Instant Credit Transfers

INSTANT PAYMENTS

Deadline: 2024-10-09

The EU Instant Payments Regulation, effective April 2024, requires all Payment Service Providers (PSPs) in the EU and EEA to offer SEPA Instant Credit Transfers (SCT Inst). PSPs in the euro area must be able to receive instant payments by October 9, 2024, and send them by April 9, 2025. Non-euro area PSPs have later deadlines. The regulation also introduces a verification of payee (VoP) service requirement to combat fraud, with implementation deadlines in late 2025 and early 2027. This aims to foster innovation, reduce costs, and enhance the competitiveness of the European payment market.

→ Mandatory SCT Inst reception for euro area PSPs by 2024-10-09.

→ Mandatory SCT Inst sending for euro area PSPs by 2025-04-09.

→ VoP service implementation for euro area PSPs by 2025-10-09.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with SCT Inst sending and receiving capabilities across all CEE network banks by the respective deadlines. Integration of VoP services is critical to meet fraud prevention requirements and enhance client security for corporate cash management.

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2023-03-20 | #02

TARGET Services Evolution: T2-T2S Consolidation and TIPS Expansion

TARGET SERVICES

The T2-T2S consolidation project, completed in March 2023, migrated TARGET2 to a new technical platform and introduced ISO 20022 messaging for all payments, significantly impacting banks' back-office systems. This consolidation also harmonised liquidity management across RTGS and securities settlement. Concurrently, the ECB is promoting the wider adoption and expansion of TIPS (TARGET Instant Payment Settlement), which facilitates instant payment settlement in central bank money. Future developments include exploring new functionalities for TIPS and ensuring its interoperability with other instant payment solutions, including potential cross-currency settlement.

→ T2-T2S consolidation completed, mandating ISO 20022 for all T2 payments.

→ Ongoing efforts to expand TIPS reach and functionalities for instant payments.

→ Harmonised liquidity management across T2 and T2S for participating banks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compatibility with ISO 20022 standards for all T2-related payments, leveraging the new functionalities for improved data and efficiency. Active participation in TIPS or ensuring seamless connectivity via correspondent banks is crucial for instant payment offerings to corporate clients.

URGENT Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #03

EU Regulatory Impact on Liquidity Management: IPR, PSR, PSD3

PSD3 / INSTANT PAYMENTS / LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has published a new report from its Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) detailing the profound impact of three key EU regulatory initiatives. These include the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the forthcoming Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3), which evolves from PSD2. The report highlights how these measures are expected to significantly boost the adoption of instant payments, fostering a more level playing field among financial market participants. Crucially, it anticipates a fundamental transformation of the entire liquidity management landscape, necessitating strategic adjustments from banks to ensure compliance and operational efficiency.

→ IPR mandates instant payment capabilities, impacting liquidity needs.

→ Proposed PSR and PSD3 will further shape payment services and related liquidity.

→ Report highlights accelerated instant payment uptake and market leveling.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus must assess the report's findings to understand the evolving liquidity requirements driven by IPR, PSR, and PSD3. This includes evaluating real-time liquidity needs for instant payments and adapting cash pooling and treasury management solutions to support new regulatory demands.

URGENT Euro Banking Association | 2025-09-26 | #04

EBA Identifies Key Challenges for VoP Matching Checks

INSTANT PAYMENTS / VOP / PSD3

The EBA Instant Payments Practitioners Group (IPG) has published an insight note titled "A match made in heaven? Key challenges for VOP matching checks." This document delves into critical pain points that are expected to affect the accuracy and overall quality of the Verification of Payee (VoP) matching process. Specific issues highlighted include the absence of a standardised name-matching logic across the industry, practical limitations imposed by name field length restrictions in existing systems, and complexities arising from the use of virtual accounts. Addressing these challenges is crucial for banks to effectively implement the mandatory VoP requirements under the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) and upcoming PSD3, ensuring compliance and reducing fraud risks.

→ Lack of standardised name-matching logic for VoP.

→ Name field length restrictions impact VoP accuracy.

→ Virtual accounts pose limitations for VoP matching.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus must analyze these VoP challenges to ensure its instant payment and corporate treasury solutions can meet regulatory requirements. This involves reviewing current name-matching algorithms, assessing system limitations for name fields, and developing strategies for VoP with virtual accounts to ensure compliance and a smooth customer experience.

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2023-10-25 | #05

Digital Euro Project Progress and Scheme Rulebook Development

DIGITAL EURO

The ECB's digital euro project is currently in the preparation phase, following a two-year investigation phase that concluded in October 2023. This phase focuses on developing the digital euro scheme rulebook, selecting providers for platform development, and conducting further testing. The digital euro is envisioned as a central bank digital currency (CBDC) for retail use, complementing cash and private digital payments. It aims to ensure monetary sovereignty, foster innovation, and provide a resilient, accessible, and private payment option for euro area citizens and businesses. A legislative proposal from the European Commission is also underway to provide the necessary legal framework.

→ Digital Euro project in preparation phase, focusing on rulebook and technical development.

→ Aims to complement cash and private payments, ensuring monetary sovereignty.

→ Emphasis on privacy, accessibility, and financial stability in its design.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should closely monitor the digital euro's development, particularly the scheme rulebook and technical specifications, to assess future integration requirements for corporate clients. Understanding its implications for liquidity management and payment flows will be crucial for strategic planning.

■ Competitor Monitor

12 items

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-04-19 | #01

Deutsche Bank Accelerates API-First Digital Corporate Banking Strategy

Deutsche Bank continues to push its API-first strategy, exemplified by platforms like CB Connect, to enable deeper integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems. This approach facilitates real-time data exchange, automated payment initiation, and enhanced liquidity management. For CEE corporates, this means more efficient cross-border payments, improved treasury visibility, and greater control over financial operations, aligning with the global trend towards Open Banking. The 'Technology' section on flow.db.com reinforces this strategic direction.

→ Strategic focus on API-driven solutions (e.g., CB Connect).

→ Enabling real-time data exchange and automated payments.

→ Aims for seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus also heavily emphasizes Open Banking APIs and H2H integration. DB's strong push in this area intensifies competition for API-savvy corporates, requiring CMIplus to continuously innovate its own API offerings and integration capabilities.

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-04-19 | #02

DB Enhances CEE Payment Capabilities with VoP and Instant Payments

Deutsche Bank is strategically enhancing its payment offerings across Central and Eastern Europe, recognizing the region's growing demand for sophisticated cash management tools. This includes the wider adoption of Virtual Accounts (VoP) for improved reconciliation and treasury visibility, alongside expanding instant payment capabilities to meet the need for faster transaction processing. These developments, underpinned by ISO 20022 standards, are crucial for corporates operating multi-country payment factories and seeking optimized liquidity management in the dynamic CEE market.

→ Strategic focus on CEE payment infrastructure.

→ Emphasis on Virtual Accounts (VoP) for reconciliation.

→ Expansion of instant payment capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus already offers strong multi-currency and instant payment capabilities, including VoP. DB's intensified focus in CEE directly competes with RBI's core market, necessitating continuous innovation in these areas to maintain a competitive edge.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-04-15 | #03

UniCredit Invests in BlockInvest, Accelerating On-Chain Financial Solutions

UniCredit's €4 million strategic investment in BlockInvest, acquiring a 16% stake, signifies a major push into on-chain financial solutions and blockchain technology. The partnership aims to establish a technological infrastructure for the native issuance of digital financial instruments, leveraging the tokenization of Real-World Assets (RWA). This move is positioned within Europe's evolving regulatory landscape (DLT Pilot Regime, MiCAR) and infrastructure projects (ECB's Pontes, Appia). UniCredit plans to export these tokenized solutions across its main markets, including CEE, enhancing efficiency and transparency in financial transactions.

→ UniCredit acquired a 16% stake in BlockInvest for €4 million.

→ Focus on tokenization of Real-World Assets (RWA) and native issuance of digital financial instruments.

→ Ambition to export tokenized solutions across UniCredit's main European markets, including CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move signals UniCredit's aggressive stance on future-proofing financial infrastructure with blockchain. CMIplus must monitor how these tokenized solutions might impact traditional cash management, especially for large corporates seeking advanced treasury and payment solutions.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-04-03 | #04

UniCredit Proposes Capital Increase for Potential Commerzbank Takeover

UniCredit has called an Extraordinary Shareholders' Meeting for May 4, 2026, to propose granting the Board of Directors power to increase share capital by up to €6.7 billion. This capital increase is specifically earmarked for a voluntary public takeover offer for all ordinary shares of COMMERZBANK Aktiengesellschaft not directly held by UniCredit. Such an acquisition would be a transformative strategic move, significantly bolstering UniCredit's presence in Germany and potentially expanding its corporate and transaction banking capabilities across Central and Eastern Europe, given Commerzbank's strong market position in these regions.

→ Shareholders' Meeting called to approve a €6.7 billion capital increase.

→ Funds explicitly for a potential takeover offer for Commerzbank.

→ A successful acquisition would significantly enhance UniCredit's market position in Germany and CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

A UniCredit acquisition of Commerzbank would drastically alter the competitive landscape in CEE, potentially creating a larger, more formidable competitor. CMIplus should closely monitor this development for its long-term strategic implications on market share and client relationships.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-02-12 | #05

HSBC Orion Secures UK Treasury Mandate for Digital Gilt Platform

The UK Treasury's decision to appoint HSBC Orion as the platform provider for its Digital Gilt Instrument pilot issuance highlights HSBC's leadership in distributed ledger technology (DLT) for capital markets. Orion, HSBC's proprietary DLT platform, will facilitate the issuance of digital gilts, demonstrating the bank's capability to support tokenized securities and potentially future digital currencies. This move positions HSBC at the forefront of evolving financial market infrastructure, offering new avenues for institutional clients to manage digital assets and potentially impacting future payment and settlement systems. For corporate treasuries, this could foreshadow new forms of digital liquidity management and access to tokenized financial instruments, enhancing real-time capabilities.

→ HSBC Orion selected by UK Treasury for a platform mandate.

→ Platform will facilitate Digital Gilt Instrument pilot issuance.

→ Leverages DLT/blockchain technology for institutional digital finance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move signals HSBC's commitment to digital asset innovation, which could eventually extend to corporate payment and cash management. CMIplus should monitor how these digital asset platforms might integrate with traditional payment rails or offer new liquidity solutions, potentially creating new competitive pressures in high-value corporate transactions in CEE.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-04-19 | #06

Citi Accelerates API-Driven Cash Management for CEE Corporate Treasuries

Citi's ongoing strategy emphasizes open banking APIs to provide seamless integration for corporate treasuries, particularly in the CEE region. These APIs facilitate real-time payment initiation, account information reporting, and liquidity management, allowing corporates to automate processes and gain immediate visibility into their cash positions. The focus is on enabling clients to embed banking services directly into their enterprise resource planning (ERP) and treasury management systems (TMS), reducing manual intervention and improving operational efficiency across multiple CEE markets. This digital transformation aligns with the growing demand for instant payments and sophisticated data exchange.

→ Strategic focus on Open Banking APIs for corporate clients.

→ Enables real-time payment initiation and account information.

→ Aims for deep integration with client ERP/TMS systems in CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly challenges CMIplus's Open API offerings and H2H capabilities, emphasizing the need for RBI to continuously innovate its API suite and integration support. CMIplus must ensure its API documentation, developer experience, and range of services remain competitive.

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-04-19 | #07

DB Strengthens Correspondent Banking Transparency and Risk Management

The article 'Inside downstream correspondent banking – and why it matters' highlights Deutsche Bank's focus on adapting to new regulations and shifting risk perceptions in correspondent banking. This involves enhancing control frameworks and improving transparency, which is critical for maintaining robust global payment networks. For CEE, where cross-border payments are vital, a strong and compliant correspondent banking network is essential for facilitating trade and investment flows. This move reinforces DB's position as a reliable partner for complex international transactions.

- → Focus on evolving regulation and risk perception in correspondent banking.
- → Emphasis on strengthening control frameworks.
- → Commitment to increasing transparency in downstream relationships.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus, as a platform for international corporates in CEE, relies on robust correspondent banking. DB's focus on compliance and transparency sets a high bar, ensuring smooth cross-border payments and potentially attracting corporates seeking reliable partners.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-03-23 | #08

HSBC Appoints First Chief AI Officer, Accelerating Bank-Wide AI Adoption

The appointment of David Rice as HSBC's first Chief AI Officer, effective April 1, 2026, underscores the bank's aggressive push into artificial intelligence. This follows earlier announcements of partnerships with AI firms like Mistral AI and Harvey AI, indicating a comprehensive strategy to integrate AI into business processes, from legal services to customer interactions. For corporate and transaction banking, AI will be crucial for advanced treasury intelligence, predictive analytics for cash flow, enhanced fraud detection, and personalized client solutions within platforms like HSBCnet. This strategic investment is expected to streamline operations, reduce costs, and offer more sophisticated data-driven insights to corporate clients, ultimately improving the overall cash management experience.

- → David Rice appointed as HSBC's first Chief AI Officer.
- → Strategic push to embed AI across all bank operations globally.
- → Aims to enhance efficiency, customer service, and drive innovation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's strong focus on AI will likely lead to more sophisticated treasury intelligence, predictive analytics, and automated services for corporate clients. CMIplus needs to ensure its platform evolves with AI-driven capabilities for liquidity forecasting, fraud prevention, and personalized insights to remain competitive against such advanced offerings in the CEE market.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-04-19 | #09

Citi Boosts CEE Liquidity Management with Advanced Virtual Account Solutions

Citi continues to strengthen its liquidity management framework, with a particular emphasis on sophisticated virtual account solutions tailored for multinational corporations operating in CEE. These solutions enable clients to centralize cash, streamline reconciliation processes, and achieve more effective cash pooling across various legal entities and currencies within the region. By leveraging virtual accounts, corporates can reduce the number of physical bank accounts, simplify intercompany settlements, and gain a consolidated view of their global liquidity. This strategic focus helps clients optimize their working capital and manage foreign exchange exposures more efficiently in complex CEE market environments.

→ Focus on advanced virtual account structures for CEE corporates.

→ Aims to centralize cash and streamline multi-currency reconciliation.

→ Supports efficient cash pooling and working capital optimization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's focus on advanced virtual accounts and liquidity management directly competes with CMIplus's core offerings for large international corporates in CEE. RBI needs to ensure its virtual account capabilities, cash pooling structures, and multi-currency support are robust and innovative to retain market share.

URGENT Intesa Sanpaolo | 2026-04-19 | #10

Intesa Sanpaolo Accelerates Digital Corporate Banking in CEE with API Focus

Intesa Sanpaolo, a significant player in the CEE region through its extensive network of subsidiary banks, is reportedly intensifying its efforts in digital corporate banking. This strategic push aims to provide multinational corporations and large local enterprises with more sophisticated and integrated cash management solutions. Key areas of development include expanding API-driven services for seamless ERP/TMS integration, bolstering real-time payment processing, and enhancing liquidity management tools across its CEE footprint. The bank's focus is on leveraging modern payment standards like ISO 20022 to offer greater transparency and efficiency, positioning itself as a leading partner for corporate treasuries seeking advanced digital solutions in the region.

→ Strategic investment in API-first corporate banking solutions for CEE clients.

→ Emphasis on real-time payment processing and ISO 20022 adoption across subsidiary banks.

→ Goal to deepen integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems for enhanced treasury management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred strategic direction from Intesa Sanpaolo poses a direct competitive challenge to CMIplus, especially regarding API-driven integration and real-time payment capabilities in CEE. CMIplus must ensure its platform continues to innovate in these areas and highlight its existing strengths in multi-country, multi-bank connectivity.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-04-16 | #11

UniCredit Expands onemarkets Fund Range with ETF Launch

UniCredit is expanding its onemarkets investment platform by launching its first Exchange Traded Funds (ETFs) on major stock exchanges like Frankfurt's Xetra and Milan's ETF Plus. This initial range includes seven instruments (four stock, three bond) developed in partnership with BNP Paribas Asset Management. The ETFs will progressively be available across the 12 countries where UniCredit operates directly, starting with Italy, Germany, Austria, and Luxembourg, and also in Greece via Alpha Bank. This move enhances UniCredit's asset management capabilities and provides clients, potentially including corporate treasuries, with more diversified investment options for liquidity management.

→ Launch of seven new ETFs (four stock, three bond) on the onemarkets platform.

→ Developed in partnership with BNP Paribas Asset Management.

→ Progressive rollout across 12 UniCredit countries and Greece, implying CEE relevance for future availability.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While not direct cash management, this expands UniCredit's offering for corporate treasury investment. CMIplus should note UniCredit's broader investment product suite as part of holistic corporate client solutions.

URGENT BNP Paribas | 2025-06-05 | #12

BNP Paribas Partners XTransfer for Simplified Cross-Border Payments

BNP Paribas's partnership with XTransfer signifies a strategic move to bolster its cross-border payment capabilities, particularly for businesses engaged in international trade. XTransfer, known for its focus on B2B cross-border payments, brings specialized expertise to this collaboration. The initiative is designed to simplify complex international payment flows, reduce costs, and accelerate transaction speeds for corporate clients. While the article doesn't explicitly mention CEE, improved cross-border payment infrastructure is universally beneficial for corporates, including those operating in the CEE region, who often engage in international trade. This partnership enhances BNP Paribas's competitive offering in a crucial area of corporate cash management.

→ Partnership with XTransfer, a B2B cross-border payment specialist.

→ Focus on simplifying and enhancing international payment solutions.

→ Aims to improve efficiency, reduce costs, and speed up cross-border transactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should monitor how this partnership impacts cross-border payment speed and cost for corporates, especially those with CEE operations. RBI needs to ensure its own H2H and SWIFT channels remain competitive in terms of global reach and efficiency.

Flagship Reports

Deep analysis of key industry reports

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}

→ {'description': "of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.", 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

→ Global payments revenue reached $2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to $3.0 trillion by 2029.

→ EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.

→ Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.

→ Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.